take place after the transfer of power, and to ensure their continuing loyalty to the British rule.

Lt. Col. Bacon was to sit out the period of transition in Gilgit, waiting for some coherence in British policy. After Sir George Cunningham left for the UK in 1946, it is speculated that he spent a lot of time in confabulations with Lord Hastings 'Pug' Ismay and the former Prime Minister Winston Churchill.[9] They discussed the future of post-British India and the preservation of British interests. Lord Ismay was a seasoned Indian Army officer who as Churchill's Chief Military Advisor during WWII. It was necessary for George Cunningham to transfer his powers to someone who could chaperone his plans through the upcoming turbulence. Many believe that the red line of the Indian Partition was finalised in 1946, between Churchill, Ismay and Cunningham.



Image 3.3: Lord Hastings Ismay, Chief Military Advisor to Churchill